

Exosphere

Scientists divide our atmosphere into five main layers. The exosphere is the outermost layer before outer space begins.

Astronauts have flown out several times to service the Hubble Space Telescope.

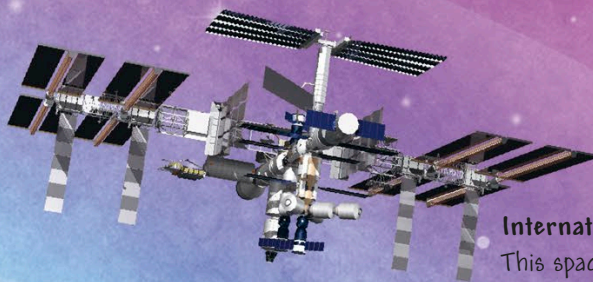


Hubble Space Telescope

Launched in 1990, this space telescope travels around the Earth, taking amazing photographs of distant stars and galaxies.

Thermosphere

This layer protects us by absorbing a lot of the dangerous energy from the Sun, such as X-rays.



International Space Station

This space station has a crew of up to six astronauts. Each stays about six months, looking after the station and doing experiments. It orbits the Earth once every 90 minutes.

Mesosphere

Most space rocks that enter the atmosphere burn up in the mesosphere. The top of this layer is the coldest part of the Earth's atmosphere.

Stratosphere

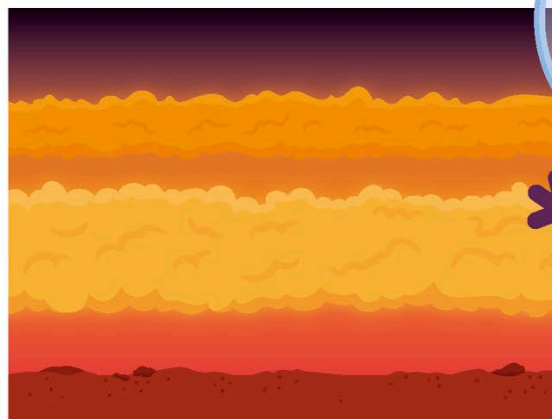
The stratosphere contains the ozone layer. Ozone is a form of oxygen. It stops harmful ultraviolet rays from the Sun reaching the Earth.

Troposphere

All of our weather happens in the troposphere. It contains most of the air we breathe and a lot of water, including clouds.

Venus's atmosphere

Venus's atmosphere contains thick layers of deadly sulphur-containing clouds. Heat from the Sun becomes trapped below these clouds. This makes Venus the hottest planet in the Solar System.



Venus's clouds trap heat below them.

The gas carbon dioxide makes up 96.5% of Venus's atmosphere.